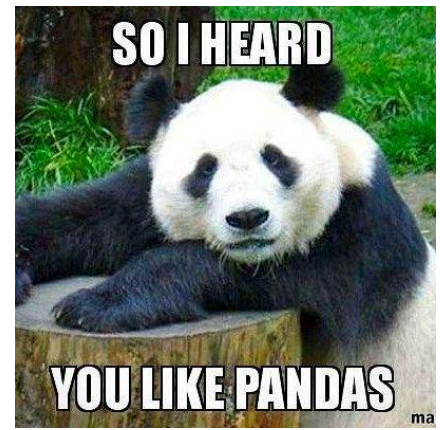




LECTURE 3

EDA & Wrangling Using Pandas

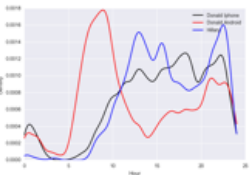
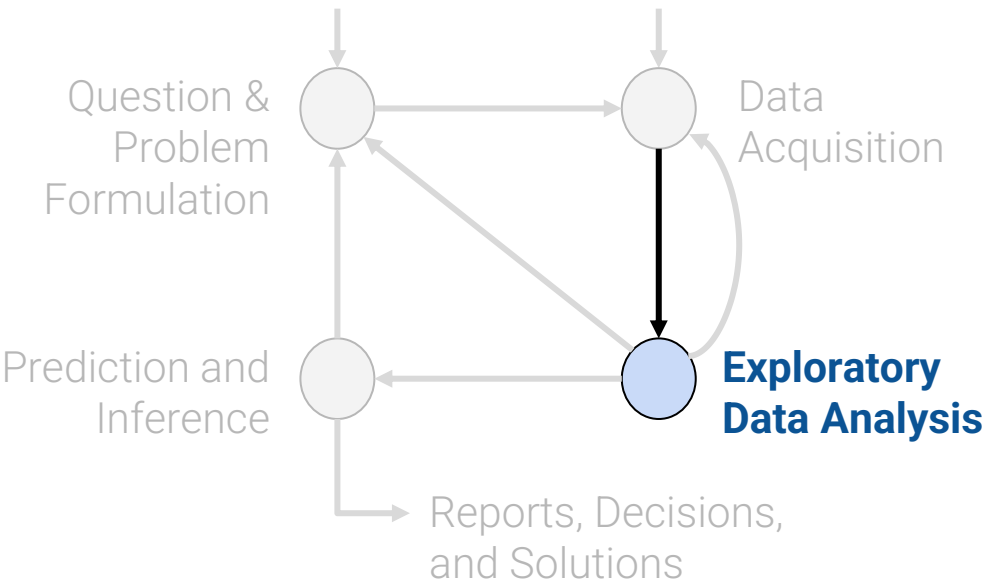
Using Pandas for Exploratory Data Analysis

CSCI 3022 @ CU Boulder

Dr. Osita Onyejekwe

Content credit: [Acknowledgments](#)

Plan for first 2 weeks



(Weeks 1)

EDA, Wrangling, and Data Visualization

Lesson 3 Learning Objectives:

- Identify 5 key data properties to consider when doing Exploratory Data Analysis
- Define what is meant by structure and granularity in terms of a set of data, and identify the structure and granularity of sample datasets
- Practice EDA with sample data

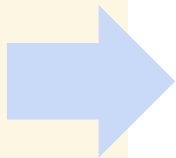
EDA & Wrangling

Lesson 3:

EDA - 5 key properties to consider

EDA Jupyter Demo

File Format
Variable Type
Multiple files
(Primary and Foreign Keys)



Structure -- the “shape” of a data file

Granularity -- how fine/coarse is each datum

Scope -- how (in)complete is the data

Temporality -- how is the data situated in time

Faithfulness -- how well does the data capture “reality”

Key Data Properties to Consider in EDA

Variables Are Columns

What does each **column** represent?

A **variable** is a **measurement** of a particular concept.

It has two common properties:

- **Datatype/Storage type:**

How each variable value is stored in memory. `df[colname].dtype`

- integer, floating point, boolean, object (string-like), etc.

Affects which pandas functions you use.

- **Variable type/Feature type:**

Conceptualized measurement of information (and therefore what values it can take on).

- Use expert knowledge
- Explore data itself
- Consult data codebook (if it exists).

Affects how you **visualize and interpret** the data.

	Year	Candidate	Party	Popular vote	Result	%
0	1824	Andrew Jackson	Democratic-Republican	151271	loss	57.210122
1	1824	John Quincy Adams	Democratic-Republican	113142	win	42.789878
2	1828	Andrew Jackson	Democratic	642806	win	56.203927
3	1828	John Quincy Adams	National Republican	500897	loss	43.796073
4	1832	Andrew Jackson	Democratic	702735	win	54.574789
...	...	...	...	...	...	...
177	2016	Jill Stein	Green	1457226	loss	1.073699
178	2020	Joseph Biden	Democratic	81268924	win	51.311515
179	2020	Donald Trump	Republican	74216154	loss	46.858542
180	2020	Jo Jorgensen	Libertarian	1865724	loss	1.177979
181	2020	Howard Hawkins	Green	405035	loss	0.255731

A **row** represents one record (i.e. an observation)

A **column** represents some characteristic, or feature, of that observation (here, the political party of that person).

Storage types say what operations we can write **code to compute**, while **feature types** say **what operations make sense for the data**.

⚠ In this class, “variable types” are conceptual!!

Ratios and intervals
have consistent
meaning.

Quantitative

Continuous

Could be measured to
arbitrary precision.

Examples:

- Price
- Temperature

Discrete

Stored as integers where
intervals have consistent
meaning

Examples:

- Number of siblings
- Yrs of education

Variable

Many variables do not sit
neatly in one of these
categories!!

Qualitative (categorical)

Ordinal

Categories w/ordered levels; no
consistent meaning to difference

Examples:

- Preferences
- Level of education

Nominal

Categories w/ no
specific ordering.

Examples:

- Political Affiliation
- CU ID number

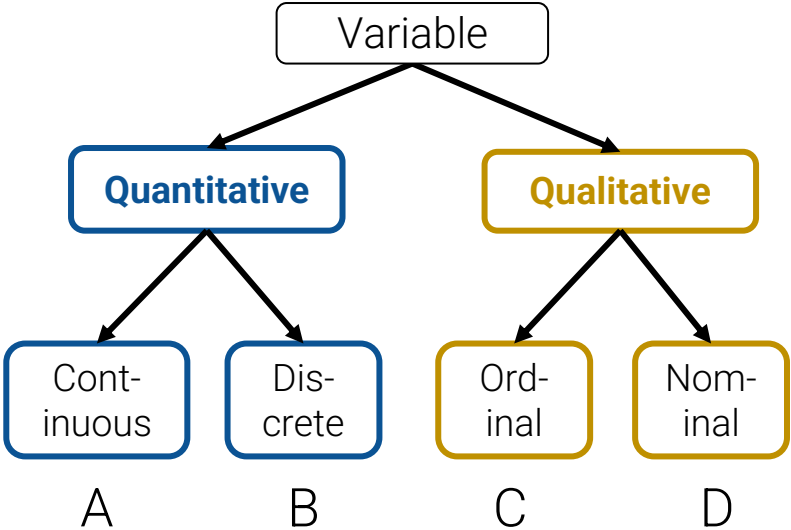
Note that **qualitative variables** could have numeric levels;
conversely, **quantitative variables** could be stored as strings!

Class Exercise



What is the feature type of each variable?

Q	Variable	Feature Type
1	CO ₂ level (PPM)	
2	Number of siblings	
3	GPA	
4	Income bracket (low, med, high)	
5	Race	
6	Number of years of education	
7	Yelp Rating	

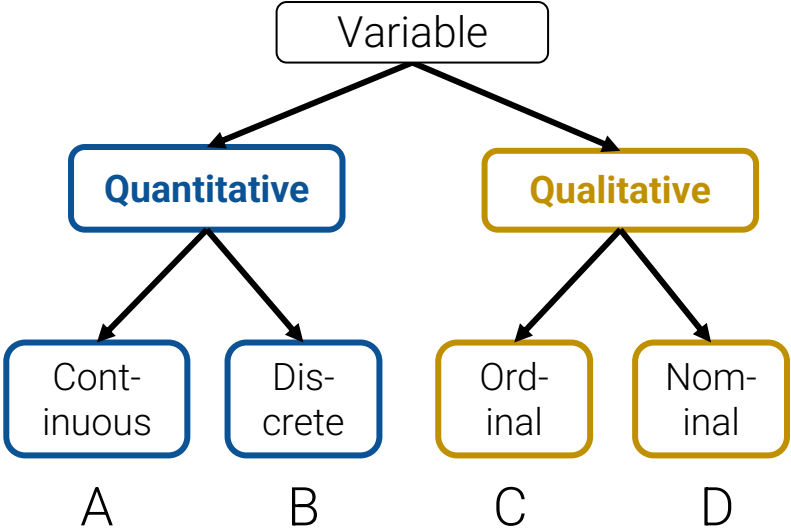


Class Exercise: Solutions



What is the feature type of each variable?

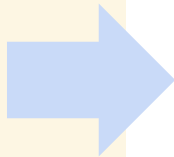
Q	Variable	Feature Type
1	CO ₂ level (PPM)	A. Quantitative Cont.
2	Number of siblings	B. Quantitative Discrete
3	GPA	A. Quantitative Cont.
4	Income bracket (low, med, high)	C. Qualitative Ordinal
5	Race	D. Qualitative Nominal
6	Number of years of education	B. Quantitative Discrete*
7	Yelp Rating	C. Qualitative Ordinal*



*see speaker notes

Meta: For this exercise, The Feature Type variable is Qualitative Nominal.

Key Data Properties to Consider in EDA



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Faithfulness -- how well does the data capture “reality”

Primary Keys

Primary key: the column or set of columns in a table that *uniquely* determine the values in the remaining columns

- Primary keys are unique, but could be tuples.
- Examples: SSN, ProductIDs, ...

Customers.csv

<u>CustID</u>	Addr
171345	Harmon..
281139	Main ..

Primary Key

Orders.csv

<u>OrderNum</u>	<u>CustID</u>	Date
1	171345	8/21/2017
2	281139	8/30/2017

Primary Key

Products.csv

<u>ProdID</u>	Cost
42	3.14
999	2.72

Purchases.csv

<u>OrderNum</u>	<u>ProdID</u>	Quantity
1	42	3
1	999	2
2	42	1

Primary Key

Primary Keys & Granularity

Primary key: the column or set of columns in a table that *uniquely* determine the values in the remaining columns

- Primary keys are unique, but could be tuples.
- Examples: SSN, ProductIDs, ...

Granularity is the **concept** the primary key represents.

Example:

Granularity of Customer's table: Each row represents data for one unique customer.

Customers.csv

<u>CustID</u>	Addr
171345	Harmon..
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Orders.csv

<u>OrderNum</u>	<u>CustID</u>	Date
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Purchases.csv

<u>OrderNum</u>	<u>ProdID</u>	Quantity
1	42	3
1	999	2
2	42	1

Granularity

What does each **record (row)** represent?

- Examples: a purchase, a person, a group of users, a house, a team

Do all records capture granularity at the same level?

- Some data will include summaries (aka **rollups**) as records

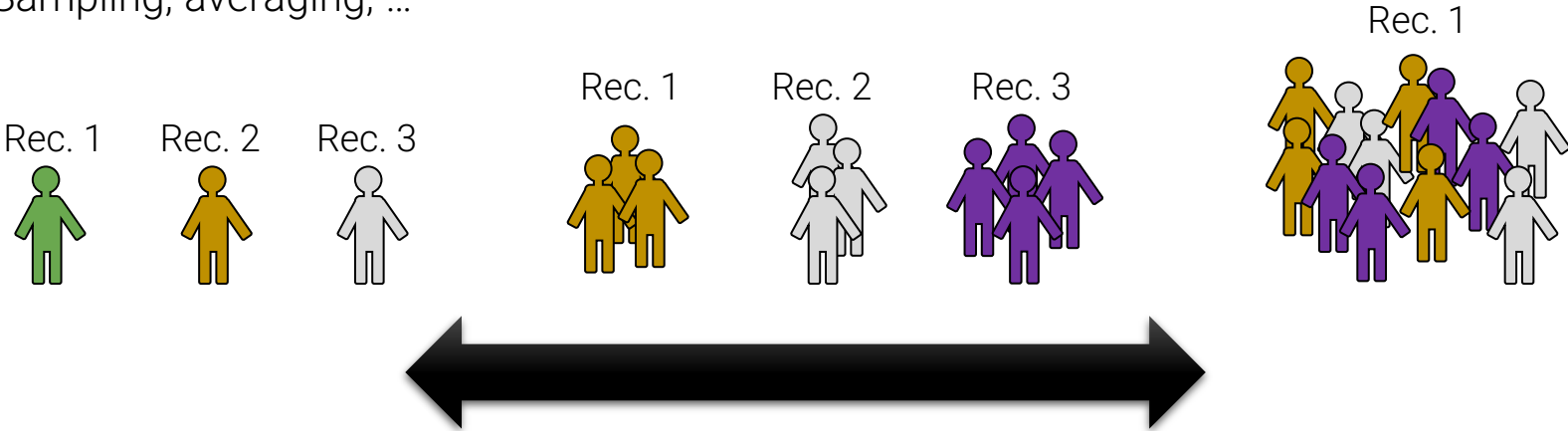
How were the records aggregated?

- Sampling, averaging, ...

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A **row** represents one record (i.e. an observation)

A **column** represents some characteristic, or feature, of that observation (here, the political party of that person).



```
elections.head()
```

	Year	Candidate	Party	Popular vote	Result	%
0	2024	Kamala Harris	Democratic	75019230	loss	48.34
1	2024	Donald Trump	Republican	77303568	win	49.81
2	2024	Jill Stein	Green	861155	loss	0.60
3	2024	Robert F. Kennedy Jr.	Independent	756383	loss	0.60
4	2024	Chase Oliver	Libertarian	650130	loss	0.40

How could we determine the granularity of the whole dataset?

Based on the first 5 rows of the DataFrame, what appears to be the granularity of the election dataset?

(i.e. each record represents data about a)

- A). Presidential Candidate
- B). Political Party
- C). Political Party in a Specific Year
- D). Presidential Candidate in a Specific Year
- E). Candidate in a Political Party

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elections.head()
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4	2024	Chase Oliver	Libertarian	650130	loss	0.40

What Pandas functions do we need to use to determine the granularity of the whole dataset?

- Need to select a subset of column(s) that we think represent granularity
- Need to a way to determine uniqueness of entries in multiple columns

Based on the first 5 rows of the DataFrame, what appears to be the granularity of the election dataset?

(i.e. each record represents data about a)

- A). Presidential Candidate
- B). Political Party
- C). Political Party in a Specific Year
- D). Presidential Candidate in a specific year
- E). Candidate in a Political Party

Key Data Properties to Consider in EDA

Structure -- the “shape” of a data file

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Scope -- how (in)complete is the data

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Will my data be enough to answer my question?

- **Example:** I am interested in studying crime in California but I only have Berkeley crime data.
- **Solution:** collect more data/change research question

Is my data too expansive?

- **Example:** I am interested in student grades for Data100 but have student grades for all Data Science classes.
- **Solution: Filtering** $\Rightarrow$ Implications on sample?
 - If the data is a sample I may have poor coverage after filtering (More on this next week)

Does my data cover the right time frame?

- Which brings us to **Temporality**

“Scope” questions are defined by your question/problem and inform if you need better-scoped data.

Data changes – when was the data collected/last updated?

Periodicity – Is there periodicity? Diurnal (24-hr) patterns?

What is the meaning of the time and date fields? A few options:

- When the “event” happened?
- When the data was collected or was entered into the system?
- Date the data was copied into a database? (look for many matching timestamps)

Time depends on where! (**time zones** & daylight savings)

- Learn to use **datetime** Python library and Pandas **dt** accessors
- Regions have different datestring representations: 07/08/09?

Are there strange null values?

- E.g., **January 1st 1970**, January 1st 1900...?



Temporality: Unix / POSIX Time

Time measured in seconds since **January 1st 1970 UTC**

- Minus leap seconds ...

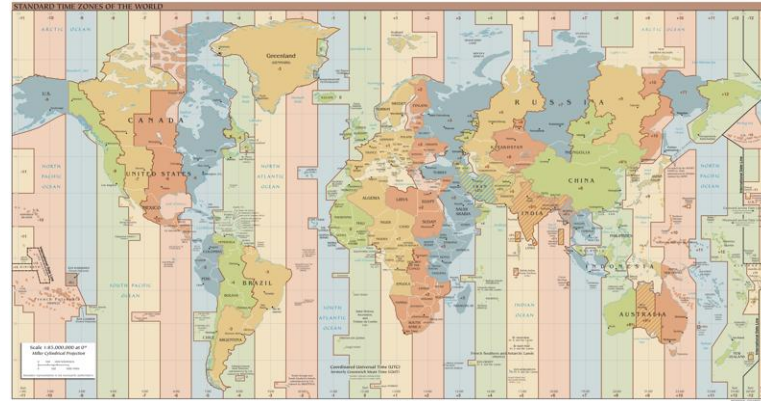
UTC is Coordinated Universal Time

- International time standard
- Measured at 0 degrees latitude
 - Similar to Greenwich Mean Time (GMT)
- No daylight savings

Time Zones:

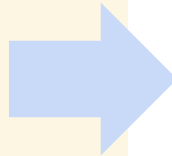
- San Francisco (**UTC-7**) with daylight savings

Jun 27, 2023 5:00pm PDT
1687910400



https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Coordinated_Universal_Time

What else?



Structure -- the “shape” of a data file

Granularity -- how fine/coarse is each datum

Scope -- how (in)complete is the data

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Faithfulness -- how well does the data capture “reality”

Faithfulness: Do I trust this data?

Does my data contain **unrealistic or “incorrect” values**?

- Dates in the future for events in the past
- Locations that don't exist
- Negative counts
- Misspellings of names
- Large outliers

Does my data violate **obvious dependencies**?

- E.g., age and birthday don't match

Was the data **entered by hand**?

- Spelling errors, fields shifted ...
- Did the form require all fields or provide default values?

Are there obvious signs of **data falsification**?

- Repeated names, fake looking email addresses, repeated use of uncommon names or fields.

Signs that your data may not be faithful (and proposed solutions)

Truncated data

Early Microsoft Excel limits: 65536 Rows, 255 Columns

Duplicated Records or Fields

Identify and eliminate (use primary key).

Spelling Errors

Apply corrections or drop records not in a dictionary

Units not specified or consistent

Infer units, check values are in reasonable ranges for data

Time Zone Inconsistencies

Convert to a common timezone (e.g., UTC)

- Be aware of consequences in analysis when using data with inconsistencies.
- Understand the potential implications for how data were collected.

Missing Data???

Examples

" "	1970, 1900
0, -1	NaN
999, 12345	Null

NaN: "Not a Number"

Missing Data/Default Values: Solutions

A. Drop records with missing values

- **Caution:** check for biases induced by dropped values
 - When modeling data you can't drop missing values in your test/validation sets
 - Missing or corrupt records might be related to something of interest

B. Keep as NaN

C. Imputation/Interpolation: Inferring missing values

- **Average Imputation:** replace with the mean
 - When the variable's distribution is roughly bell shaped, or mostly crowded at the mean
- **Median Imputation:** replace with the median
 - When the variable's distribution is skewed (not crowded at the mean, rather at the left or right of it)
- **Mode Imputation:** replace with the mode
 - When the variable is frequently going to be a specific value, there is a high chance that the mode is the right inherent value for such data
- **Zero:** Replace with zero if it makes sense in the context of the data

Choice affects bias and uncertainty quantification (large statistics literature)

Essential question: why are the records missing?

Other Imputation Strategies (out of scope for this class)

- **Hot deck imputation:** replace with a random value
- **Regression imputation:** replace with a predicted value, using some model